MSCSE requirements as the degree self-check reads them

For the Assistant DGS (ADGS) to review and sign: each MSCSE requirement, the handbook sentence it implements, how the app reads it (checked against the code by an independent reviewer) and the decision that interprets it (docs/DECISIONS.md). Prepared 2026-10-14. Checked with: course rules 87e63716 (read live, last updated on October 11, 2026) · CSE Graduate Studies Handbook (Updated September 2026) · app version c14359c of October 14, 2026.

#	REQUIREMENT	HANDBOOK SENTENCE	HOW THE APP READS IT	DECISION RECORD
1	**Cumulative GPA of 3.0**	*CSE §2.2: "Continuation in a CSE graduate degree program, admission to degree candidacy, and graduation require maintenance of at least a 3.0 (B) cumulative GPA."*	Met at a cumulative GPA of 3.0 or more (the transcript's graduate figure; a looser sheet value reads 3.0). Blank or off-scale: cannot evaluate. Transcript and program-only GPAs on opposite sides of 3.0: Conditionally met.	2026-08-31 the transcript is the truth · 2026-10-03 (P1-gpa-9) the graduate-level cumulative GPA · 2026-10-07 (P3-ac-5b-6.1-4) a looser row reads 3.0
2	**Advisor by the end of the first semester**	*CSE §2.3: "M.S. students, with assistance from the ADGS, are expected to identify a thesis or project advisor by the end of their first semester, unless an exception is granted by the ADGS."*	Met once an advisor is entered; Overdue after the entry term ends without one. Thesis option chosen: also asked whether the advisor is tenured or tenure-track CSE (No or Not sure: ADGS; unanswered: cannot evaluate).	2026-10-02 deadline = end of the entry term · 2026-10-04 (P2-dh-10-5) asked on the thesis option only · 2026-10-07 (P3-cross-doc-2) a non-TTT advisor needs a TTT co-advisor
3	**Good standing (only on probation)**	*Academic Code §5.7.1: "Students must be in good standing to receive a graduate degree."*	Shown only while a probation letter's deadline is entered under Your standing; reads In progress with that deadline.	2026-10-04 (P2-ac-5b-6.1-2, -3) a scored row with the letter's deadline, behind a selector
4	**30 total credits**	*CSE §3.2: "The graduate school requires a total of thirty (30) credits of courses and research for the M.S. degree."*	Met at 30 completed credits (C or better, or S) after the allowance caps; In progress if courses in progress would reach 30; Conditionally met if courses awaiting an approval would. Non-CSE credit beyond nine counts nowhere.	2026-08-31 only passed courses count · 2026-09-12 no C- or D toward a credit requirement · 2026-10-03 non-CSE beyond nine counts toward nothing
5	**24 regular-course credits**	*CSE §3.2: "… twenty-four (24) credit hours of regular courses … Research seminar, research credits, independent study, and other similar courses do not count as regular courses."*	Courses the Courses tab types regular, at the 60000 level or higher, plus the CSE 40000-level (six) and non-CSE (nine) allowances. Seminars, research, and a posted thesis or independent study count toward the 30 only.	2026-08-31 4xxxx inside the 24, up to six; 5xxxx nothing · 2026-10-04 (P1-sheet-40) seminars: the 30 only · 2026-10-11 (P4-transfer-8) posted thesis: the 30 only
6	**6 project or thesis credits**	*CSE §3.2: "… and six (6) credits hours of Masters project (CSE 68902) or Masters thesis direction (CSE 68901) earned at Notre Dame."*	Six credits of CSE 68901 or 68902, in any mix, on either route, earned at Notre Dame (a 4+1's pre-bachelor's ones included); such credit from elsewhere never counts.	2026-08-31 either course number · 2026-09-11 six of 68902 or six of 68901 · 2026-10-03 (P1-units-4plus1-17) pre-bachelor's 68901/68902 count
7	**Transfer credit**	*CSE §5.2: "… from an unfinished M.S. program may not transfer more than six (6) semester credit hours … If the student has completed a M.S. or Ph.D. program, they may transfer up to nine (9) …"*	Graduate courses from elsewhere, B or better, within five years before admission, once the course rules say yes or the ADGS approves: up to 9 credits after a finished degree, else 6 (the page's working limit with no earlier program or an unfinished Ph.D.); posted credit counts in full. Met once recorded.	2026-09-11 the 9 / 6 caps, the five-year window · 2026-10-03 (P2-dh-3.14-3.20-5) met once recorded · 2026-10-06 (P3-cse-5-6-1) working limit · 2026-10-11 (P4-transfer-2, -3) · 2026-10-12 (P4-transfer-4)
8	**At most 6 credits below 60000**	*CSE §3.2: "Up to six (6) credits at the 40000 level may count toward both the graduate school's 30-credit requirement and the department's 24-credit regular course requirement, subject to approval by the advisor and the ADGS."*	CSE 40000-level courses count inside the 24 and the 30, up to six credits: a Courses-tab yes counts outright, adgs_approval waits for the ADGS. Non-CSE 40000-level and CSE 50000-level courses count nothing.	2026-08-31 non-CSE 40000-level never count · 2026-10-03 (P1-levels-grades-credits-8) yes is the pre-approval; (-4) 50000-level refused
9	**At most 6 credits shared with the bachelor's (4+1)**	*CSE §3.5: "With approval of the instructor and DGS, students in the integrated B.S. + M.S. program may … take one or two 3-credit CSE regular courses at the 60000 level or higher, and count these both …"*	CSE 40000-level first (best grade), then 60000-level regular courses from the junior spring on, UG-registered or level not shown before GR, earliest first. One the bachelor's did not use counts toward the MSCSE alone for a 4+1 admitted before the bachelor's (or undated); one admitted after gets only the shared six.	2026-09-11 40000-level first; students do not choose · 2026-10-03 (P1-units-4plus1-12) 40000 or 60000 level · 2026-10-07 (P3-fourplusone-1, P3-sheet-5) · 2026-10-11 (P4-mscse-4) UG first · 2026-10-12 (P4-transfer-7)
10	**At most 9 credits from outside CSE**	*CSE §3.2: "Up to nine (9) credits at the 60000 level or higher taken from a department other than CSE may count toward both … subject to approval by the advisor and the ADGS."*	Non-CSE courses at the 60000 level or higher count toward the 24 and the 30, up to nine credits, as the course rules decide; beyond nine they count nowhere. ECE counts as CSE.	2026-10-03 beyond nine counts toward nothing · 2026-08-31 non-CSE 40000-level never count · 2026-10-04 (P1-sheet-c1) ECE inside CSE
11	**At most 9 credits shared with a second degree**	*Academic Code §2.2: "No more than nine credit hours of classes from any one master's degree may be counted toward any other graduate degree."*	Shown when the student ticks a course as also counting toward a concurrent Notre Dame degree: up to nine credits, Conditionally met until the Graduate School approves the dual-degree plan of study.	2026-10-04 (P2-ac-1-3-2) a nine-credit allowance · 2026-10-06 (P3-dh-front-1-2-2) waits on the Graduate School, not the ADGS
12	**One full-time semester or summer**	*CSE §3.3: "The minimum residency requirement for the M.S. degree is registration in full-time status for one semester during the academic year or for one summer session."*	Met by a fall or spring with 9 or more registered credits (or ticked full-time), a summer with 6 or more, or summer registration beside a full-time spring or fall that year. Conditionally met if that semester had under 3 credits at the 60000 level.	2026-08-31 nine entered credits, or the full-time tick · 2026-10-04 (P1-page-text-ui-9) a summer at six · 2026-10-03 (P1-residency-enrollment-c5) Academic Code §4.1
13	**All requirements within 5 years**	*CSE §3.3: "Failure to complete all requirements for the M.S. degree within 5 years results in forfeiture of degree eligibility."*	Five years from entry (+6 months per medical-leave or accommodation semester, or a Graduate School extension): Met if every requirement, coursework included, is complete by then; Eligibility at risk if later; Overdue if unfinished. Summer-only record: the ADGS confirms seven.	2026-10-06 (P3-cse-3-1) coursework dated by the term it reached the minimum · (P3-cross-doc-1) medical leave moves it · 2026-10-04 (P2-dh-3.21-3.24-3) summer-only: seven
14	**Thesis topic approved (thesis, not counted)**	*CSE §3.4(ii): "A student may propose an M.S. thesis topic with the approval and supervision of their research advisor." (Academic Code §6.1.7)*	Thesis route only: done once a topic-approval date or a passed defense is entered; no deadline of its own.	2026-10-04 (P2-ac-5b-6.1-14)
15	**Thesis defense passed (thesis)**	*CSE §3.4: "Upon acceptance of the thesis by the thesis defense examination committee (advisor and two readers), the student must successfully pass the oral thesis defense examination."*	Met on a dated passed defense; Eligibility at risk after the five years; Conditionally met if the GPA was below 3.0, the defense came before a 5+-year interruption, a retake was late, or the readers are not both TTT CSE. One retake after a fail.	2026-10-03 (P1-gpa-10) below 3.0 · 2026-10-04 (P2-ac-5b-6.1-12) one retake; (P2-dh-10-19) readers · 2026-10-05 (P3-ac-5a-3) before a readmission
16	**Final thesis submitted (thesis)**	*Academic Code §6.1.8: "… the master's candidate who is completing a thesis must submit it to the Graduate School on or before the deadline published in the Graduate School calendar."*	Thesis route: In progress once the defense is dated; Met once a submission date is entered; after the five years, Eligibility at risk.	2026-10-04 (P2-ac-5b-6.1-15, P2-dh-3.21-3.24-23)
17	**Project report accepted (project)**	*CSE §3.4(i): "The project report and deliverables must be accepted and approved by the advisor to satisfy the project requirement."*	Met once the advisor's acceptance is dated (no GPA gate); Eligibility at risk after the five years; Conditionally met if dated before a 5+-year interruption. With no route chosen, either completed route satisfies both §3.4 rows.	2026-09-12 alternatives while undecided · 2026-10-03 (P1-gpa-10) not GPA-gated · 2026-10-05 (P3-ac-5a-3)
18	**Master's candidacy application (not counted)**	*Academic Code §6.1.6: "Admission to candidacy is a prerequisite to receiving any graduate degree. It is the student's responsibility to apply …"*	Shown once the GPA is 3.0 or more and 30 credits are in hand, counting those in progress (or once dated); while open it is in the processing request to the Grad Admin, and past the five years it names the passed limit.	2026-10-04 (P2-dh-3.21-3.24-2, -4) · 2026-10-11 (P4-mscse-2 (b)) the passed limit named
19	**Approvals (informational)**	*CSE §3.2: "All courses taken by a student must have the approval of their advisor."*	Not scored: the courses waiting on the ADGS (Conditionally met), the advisor or the Graduate School's dual-degree approval (In progress), and the student's tick that the advisor approved the coursework.	2026-08-31 the approval ticks · 2026-09-07 grouped by who must act · 2026-10-08 "approved my coursework"
20	**MSCSE along the way (Ph.D. students)**	*CSE §4.5: "… thus earning the MSCSE degree on successfully passing the candidacy exam, given that all the credits used to satisfy the requirements were earned at Notre Dame." (§3.1: decided by the DGS)*	OCE passed and 24 regular + 6 research credits at Notre Dame: Qualifies until asked for (the tick or a dated application), then Met (= §3.1's DGS review). Waits for the DGS if the GPA is under 3.0 or blank, the OCE waits, or either came after the master's five years.	2026-09-04 OCE + 24 + 6 at Notre Dame · 2026-10-03 (P1-deadlines-20) · 2026-10-07 (P3-dh-3.21-3.24-2, P3-cse-3-2) · 2026-10-11 (3(a) (b), P4-phd-5, P4-mscse-3)
21	**Candidacy application for that award**	*DGS Handbook §3.21.1: "A doctoral student who wishes to receive a master's degree must also apply for admission to master's degree candidacy."*	Not counted: shown once the award along the way is met and asked for (or dated); while open it is in the processing request beside the award.	2026-10-04 (P2-dh-3.21-3.24-4) · 2026-10-11 (3(a) (b)) only when asked

Conditionally met = waiting for the ADGS or DGS; Eligibility at risk = done after the time limit. Updated 2026-10-14 for the round-4 rulings (all resolved) and the round-5 review.

Reviewed: the readings above implement the handbook as the department applies it, except as noted beside a row.

Assistant Director of Graduate Studies (signature)

Date